

OpenEMR Hospital & Medical Practice User Manual

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OpenEMR is a comprehensive Electronic Health Records (EHR) and Medical Practice Management system used by hospitals, clinics, and medical practices worldwide.

What OpenEMR Manages

Patient records and medical history

Appointments and scheduling

Doctor consultations and encounters

Prescriptions and medications

Lab orders and results

Billing and insurance claims

Reporting and compliance

Typical Hospital Workflow

1. Patient Arrival & Check-In

Receptionists register patients, verify identity, update demographics, insurance information, and check patients into appointments.

2. Appointment Scheduling

Appointments are booked with providers, and statuses move from Scheduled → Checked In → In Progress → Completed.

3. Doctor Encounter

Providers document:

Chief complaint

History of Present Illness (HPI)

Physical examination findings

Assessment and diagnosis

Treatment plan

4. Prescriptions & Medication Management

Doctors prescribe medications electronically while the system checks allergies, interactions, and duplicates.

5. Labs & Imaging

Lab technicians receive test orders, upload results, and radiologists store imaging reports and DICOM files.

6. Billing & Claims

OpenEMR generates insurance claims using CPT and ICD-10 codes and tracks payments, copays, deductibles, and balances.

Key Sections in OpenEMR

Patient Dashboard: Central hub for demographics, medications, allergies, and appointments.

Calendar & Scheduling: Appointment booking and provider calendars.

Encounters & Visits: Clinical documentation and visit management.

Medications: Prescription and medication tracking.

Labs & Results: Orders, trends, and lab integrations.

Documents: Scanned records, reports, and referrals.

Billing: Claims, fee sheets, payments, and patient statements.

Reports: Financial and clinical reporting tools.

User Roles & Permissions

Role	Can Do	Cannot Do
Receptionist	Register patients, schedule appointments	Write prescriptions
Medical Assistant	Enter vitals, scan documents	Diagnose patients
Nurse	Document care, administer medications	Usually cannot prescribe
Doctor/Provider	Diagnose, prescribe, order tests	Depends on admin permissions
Lab Technician	Enter lab results	Billing and prescribing
Billing Staff	Process payments and claims	Clinical care
Administrator	Manage users and reports	Direct patient care

Real-World Example: A Patient Visit

Patient: Maria Rodriguez

Chief Complaint: Cold symptoms for 3 days

Vitals: Blood Pressure: 120/80 Temperature: 99.5°F Heart Rate: 88 bpm **Assessment:** ICD-10 J00 - Common Cold

Billing: CPT 99213 Office Visit = \$100

Insurance: Patient owes \$30 copay.

Key Features Hospitals Love

- Electronic Health Records (EHR)
- Integrated Scheduling
- Clinical Decision Support
- ePrescribing
- Lab Integration
- Billing & Claims Management
- Patient Portal
- Mobile Access

- HIPAA Compliance
- FHIR API Support

Official Resources

- Official Documentation: <https://www.open-emr.org/wiki>
- User Guide: https://www.open-emr.org/wiki/index.php/OpenEMR_8.0.0_Users_Guide
- Community Forum: <https://community.open-emr.org/>
- Demo System: <https://www.open-emr.org/demo>

Summary: OpenEMR helps healthcare facilities manage patients, scheduling, clinical documentation, prescriptions, labs, billing, reporting, and compliance in one integrated system.